

Solis-Grave Dungeon Master's Guide

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Consolidated rules reference for running the campaign.

Magic System

Solis-Grave Magic System — Formal Rules

Spell Safety DC

Every time a character casts a spell of 1st level or higher, they must make a Constitution saving throw against:

Spell Safety DC = 20 - (Blood Purity Percentage / 5)

Aether Burn

Purity	DC	Safe Spells
0% (Blank)	20	None — cantrips only with DM permission
10%	18	Cantrips only (1st+ nearly impossible)

15% (Lesser Blood)	17	Cantrips safe, 1st+ very risky
25%	15	1st level passable with good CON
40% (Archon)	12	1st-3rd level manageable
60%	8	1st-5th level easy
80%	4	1st-7th level nearly automatic
95%+ (Sovereign, Dormant)	2	SEEMINGLY easy but MIND BLOCKS casting while dormant
95%+ (Sovereign, Awakened)	Auto-pass	All spells auto-pass. No save needed.

On failure: The ambient magic cooks the caster's veins from the inside. Damage = 1d6 per spell level.

Spell Level Failed	Damage
1st	1d6
2nd	2d6
3rd	3d6
...	...
9th	9d6

Damage type: Fire (default) or matches the spell's element.

IGNORES ALL RESISTANCES. Cannot be reduced by any standard means.

Exceptions: Sump-Blood racial immunity, Aether-Warded armor enchantment (reduce by 1d6).

Purity Gating

Components & Focuses

Purity	Access
0% (Blank)	Cantrips with DM permission only. Cannot cast 1st+ spells.
1-14% (Common)	Cannot legally cast magic. No spell access.
15-39% (Lesser Blood)	Cantrips + 1st level. 2nd+ possible but DC high.
40-85% (Archon)	Full spell access up to 6th level. 7th+ requires 70%+.
90-94% (Scion)	Full spell access. Cataclysmic energy.
95-100% (Sovereign, Dormant)	MIND BLOCKS all casting. Appears as 0% Blank.
95-100% (Sovereign, Awakened)	ALL spells auto-pass. No Spell Safety needed.

- **Material components:** Can be replaced by an Aether-Core of matching tier (Fractured for 1st-2nd, Intact for 3rd-5th, Pristine for 6th-8th, Sovereign-Fragment for 9th).
- **Arcane Focus:** Using a focus reduces Spell Safety DC by 1.
- **Blood Focus (Blood Purist subclass):** Using own blood as focus reduces Spell Safety DC by 2. Costs 1 HP per spell level.

- **No component/focus:** Spell Safety DC as normal. No modifiers.

Wild Aether Surge (d100)

When a caster fails their Spell Safety save by 10 or more, roll on this table INSTEAD of taking standard Aether Burn:

Sovereign Subconscious Blocking

d100	Effect
01-05	Caster turns invisible until end of next turn
06-10	A random creature within 30 ft. takes the Aether Burn instead
11-15	Caster's blood purity temporarily reads as 0% for 1 hour
16-20	Spell succeeds but at half damage/healing
21-25	Caster ages 1d10 years
26-30	A Abomination (CR appropriate) is summoned 30 ft. away
31-35	Caster's voice is stolen for 1d4 hours
36-40	Spell ricochets — targets a random creature instead
41-45	Caster and target swap positions
46-50	Area becomes difficult terrain in 20 ft. radius (Aether sludge)
51-55	Caster's hands glow for 1 hour — disadvantage on Stealth
56-60	Spell creates loud thunderclap — all within 300 ft. hear it
61-65	Caster takes 1 level of Exhaustion

66-70	Spell works perfectly — no damage, no side effects
71-75	Nearby Blood Crystals within 30 ft. shatter
76-80	Caster's maximum HP reduced by spell level until long rest
81-85	Random cantrip also fires at nearest creature
86-90	Caster floats 10 ft. up for 1 minute
91-95	Aether Burn damage DOUBLED
96-99	TRIPLE Aether Burn — veins visibly crack
00	Roll twice and apply both. If 00 again, caster's blood purity PERMANENTLY drops by 5.

A dormant Sovereign (95-100% purity, unawakened) has Spell Safety DC 2. However, their MIND actively blocks any spellcasting attempt. They CANNOT cast spells of any level. If they try, the spell simply fails — no Aether Burn, no effect. The subconscious blocks it before the magic can form. This block dissolves upon Awakening.

Spell Safety Modifiers

Story Engine & Campaign Structure

Solis-Grave Story Engine — Plot Generation & Consistency Rules

Core Principle

Modifier	Source
-1	Using an Arcane Focus
-2	Blood Purist subclass — using own blood as focus (also costs 1 HP/spell level)
-2	Sovereign's Edge weapon enchantment (50%+ purity required)
+2	Casting without any focus or components
+5	Blood-Judge's "Impure" sentence (temporary)
Disadvantage	Aetheric Backlash spell (reaction, cast on you)
Advantage	Dragon-Bone Charm (consumed on use)

You are telling a CAMPAIGN, not a one-shot. Every small mission builds toward medium missions, which build toward epic arcs. Nothing is filler — everything connects eventually.

Plot Thread Management

Track every active thread in the campaign. Each thread has:

- Thread ID:** short label (e.g., "cult_cell_citadel", "obsidian_conspiracy")

- **Status:** seeded, developing, climax, resolved
- **Introduced:** Which session/event planted this seed
- **Key NPCs:** Who is involved
- **Faction:** Which House/group benefits
- **Player hook:** Why the party cares

Thread Lifecycle

SEEDED (Session N): A clue, rumor, or NPC encounter hints at something bigger. ↓ DEVELOPING (Sessions N+2 to N+5): The party investigates. More clues. A minor confrontation. ↓ CLIMAX (Sessions N+6 to N+8): Direct confrontation. Major choice. Faction involvement. ↓ RESOLVED (Session N+9): Aftermath. NPCs react. World state changes. Seeds for next arc planted.

Active Thread Template

At campaign start, 3 threads are seeded:

1. **Blood Scan Threat** — The Citadel conducts purity scans. How does the party avoid exposure?
2. **Cult Recruitment** — A mysterious figure approaches the party. Are they friend or Cult operative?
3. **House Rivalry** — Two House cadets are feuding. Whichever side the party picks makes an enemy of the other.

After each session, the DM updates thread statuses. Resolved threads spawn new seeds.

Pacing Rules

Session Types (Cycle Through These)

Type	Frequency	Description
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Action/Combat	Every 1-2 sessions	Combat encounter, chase, stealth infiltration, physical challenge
Investigation/RP	Every 2-3 sessions	Talk to NPCs, gather clues, negotiate, explore a new location
Lore/Discovery	Every 3-4 sessions	Learn about a House secret, read ancient text, visit a temple, dream sequence
Shop/Downtime	Every 4-5 sessions	Buy/sell gear, train, craft, carouse, heal, long rest with story beats
Climax/Boss	End of each arc	Major combat, revelation, choice, or escape

Never run more than 3 combat-heavy sessions in a row. Never more than 2 pure investigation sessions without excitement.

Level-Appropriate Content

Generated Mission Templates

Party Level	What They Face	XP Per Session (Total)
1-2	Goblins, bandits, minor cultists, training exercises	50-200
3-4	Orc raiders, lesser drakes, Cult initiates, Inquisitor cadets	150-400
5-6	Abominations (Stitched), House guards, Wyvern hatchlings	300-700
7-9	Full Abominations, Archon enforcers, Drake adults, Penitent cells	500-1,200

10-12	Inquisitor strike teams, Tenebris experiments, young Archon dragons	800-2,000
13-15	Scion encounters, House leaders, Cathedral assaults	1,500-3,000
16-18	Sovereign-adjacent beings, Church High Council, elder dragons	2,500-5,000
19-20	The Betrayed awakens, Sovereign confrontation, world-shaking events	5,000-10,000

When you need to fill time between major plot points, generate a mission from these tables:

Small Missions (1-2 sessions)

Medium Missions (2-4 sessions)

Ascension System & Character Creation

**Agent 5: Ascension System & Character
Creation Rules**

d12	Mission
1	A merchant's caravan was attacked on the Northern Road — investigate and recover stolen goods
2	A young Blank recruit is being bullied by Archon cadets — intervene or stay silent
3	Strange lights flicker in the Sulfur Wastes at night — locals are terrified
4	A Church Blood-Judge is auditing the Citadel — avoid scrutiny or help a friend hide
5	Sump-canals are flooding the lower barracks — find the blockage
6	A House Ferrum patrol hasn't reported in — find them in the borderlands
7	A Core-Thief offers to sell you Fractured Aether-Cores at suspicious prices
8	An Ash-Walker refugee begs for shelter — helping them risks Church attention
9	A betting ring has formed around the Citadel training duels — someone's fixing fights
10	A Deep-Blood scholar seeks escorts to a pre-Sovereign ruin — dangerous but lucrative
11	The mess hall food is being poisoned — who's targeting recruits?
12	A Bone-Wrought construct is malfunctioning — it keeps repeating "she's coming"
d10	Mission
1	A Cult of the Sixth cell is operating in the Citadel's underbelly — infiltrate or expose them
2	House Tenebris "recruiters" are kidnapping Blanks for experiments — track them to their lab
3	An Inquisitor has gone rogue, executing without trial — the Church wants them stopped quietly
4	A Wyvern has made a nest in the northern pass — trade routes are cut off
5	A Blood Crystal shipment has been hijacked — find it before it's used for illegal Ascension tests
6	House Vortex and House Ignis are on the

You are the **Ourobora Lifepath Architect**. Build the complete Day of Ascension ritual system, blood purity determination mechanics, aging rules, and character creation procedures for the Solis-Grave campaign setting.

World Context

The Day of Ascension is the single most important day in any person's life in Ourobora. At a race-specific age (generally 15 for humans, varying by race), every child undergoes the Blood Crystal test. A drop of blood touches an alchemical crystal — it reads the Dragon-Blood Purity percentage. This one moment determines caste, legal rights, marriage eligibility, military rank, and whether someone can legally cast magic. A high reading elevates entire families. A 0% reading makes someone legally a non-person.

Part 1: The Day of Ascension Ritual

The Ceremony

The ritual is administered by an ordained Inquisitor of the Church of the Five Skulls (or a House Obsidian Blood-Judge, depending on region). It is performed in public, before the community, on a specific day each year — Ascension Day (1st of Frostfall). Every child who turned the Ascension age that year participates.

The Process:

1. The child approaches the stone pedestal where the Blood Crystal rests — a fist-sized obsidian crystal with veins of dormant crimson running through it.
2. The administering Inquisitor pricks the child's left palm with a ceremonial glass dagger (the "Truth-Blade").
3. A single drop of blood falls onto the crystal.
4. The crystal reads the purity. It glows:
 - **No glow / dull gray (0%):** Blank. Silence from the crowd. The child is legally nothing.
 - **Faint crimson pulse (1-14%):** Common. Quiet murmurs. The family breathes.

- **Steady red glow (15-39%):** Lesser Blood. Respectful nods. The family gains minor standing.

- **Bright flame-like glow (40-85%):** Archon. Gasps, cheers. The family is elevated to nobility if not already. Marriage proposals begin immediately.

- **Blinding white-gold light (90-94%):** Scion. Screams, chaos. Church officials rush forward. The child is immediately taken into Obsidian custody "for training."

- **Crystal explodes (95-100%):** Sovereign. The crystal SHATTERS from the purity reading. The child is immediately killed on Church orders — or hidden by those who know the truth. This has not happened publicly in 500 years. The last time was the Sixth Sovereign.

Legal Ramifications:

- 0% (Blank): No right to own property, marry, or testify in court. Cannot be legally murdered, only "property damage" charged against owner.
- 1-14% (Common): Full rights. May own property, marry, testify. Cannot legally cast magic.

- 15-39% (Lesser Blood): Same as Common. May legally cast cantrips. 1st+ level spells require Church permit.
- 40%+ (Archon): May cast magic freely. May serve in government. May own Blanks.
- 90%+ (Scion/Sovereign): Immediate Church custody. Legal status: classified.

The Blood Crystal

- Crystals are harvested from the corpse-beds of ancient Sovereigns — their crystallized blood.
- An active crystal is worth ~50 GC. A flawed one (inaccurate) is ~5 GC.
- Portable testing kits exist (50 GC) but are illegal without an Obsidian permit.

- Forging a purity reading requires: pristine crystal powder, sovereign blood sample, and DC 20 Alchemist's Supplies check.
-

Part 2: Blood Purity Determination Methods

Method A: DM-Assigned (Recommended for Main Characters)

The DM assigns purity based on the character's backstory, narrative role, and intended arc. This is the default for player characters.

Guidelines for DMs:

- 0-14%: Standard adventurer. No magic. Relies on martial skill, grit, wits.
- 15-39%: Capable of cantrips and low-level magic with risk. Needs Spell Safety saves.

- 40-85%: Full caster capable. Noble background possible. Political entanglements certain.
 - 90-94%: Chosen one territory. NPCs will hunt or worship you. Dual-Heartbeat active.
 - 95-98%: The MC Arc.
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Equipment & Enchantments

Agent 3: Equipment, Weapons, Armor & Enchantments Builder

You are the **Ourobora Arsenal Architect**. Build the complete equipment system for the Solis-Grave campaign setting.

World Context

Solis-Grave's weaponry and armor reflect its Houses. House Pyre forges steel with dragon-fire. House Ferrum builds the heaviest plate. House Vortex crafts lightweight aerial gear. House Obsidian creates glass-blade ceremonial weapons. House Tenebris experiments with flesh-bound equipment. The currency system is split: Gold Imperial Crowns for nobles, Copper Sump Farthings for commoners. Enchantments are rare and require blood purity to activate.

Part 1: Currency System

Currency	Value	Used By	Abbreviation
Gold Imperial Crown (GC)	1 GC = 100 SS = 10,000 CF	Nobility, major purchases	gc
Silver Scale (SS)	1 SS = 100 CF	Merchants, trade	ss
Copper Sump Farthing (CF)	Base unit	Commoners, daily needs	cf

Starting wealth by class:

- Vanguard (Fighter/Barbarian): 5d4 x 10 GC

- Strider (Rogue/Ranger): 4d4 x 10 GC
 - Archon Caster (Wizard/Sorcerer): 4d4 x 10 GC (noble purse)
 - Ordained (Cleric/Paladin): 5d4 x 10 GC
 - Penitent (Warlock): 2d4 x 10 GC (outlaw purse)
 - Blank (0% purity commoner): 1d4 x 10 CF (not GC!)
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Part 2: Weapons

Simple Melee Weapons

Simple Ranged Weapons

Martial Melee Weapons

Quick Reference

Spell Safety DC

Aether Burn Damage

Name	Cost	Damage	Weight	Properties
Club (Sump-Baton)	1 ss	1d4 bludgeoning	2 lb.	Light
Dagger (Glass Shard)	2 GC	1d4 piercing	1 lb.	Finesse, light, thrown (20/60)
Greatclub (Laborer's Maul)	2 ss	1d8 bludgeoning	10 lb.	Two-handed

	Handaxe (Pyre Forge-Axe)	5 GC	1d6 slashing	2 lb.	Light, thrown (20/60)
	Javelin (Vortex Dart)	5 ss	1d6 piercing	2 lb.	Thrown (30/120)
	Light Hammer (Forge-Hammer)	2 GC	1d4 bludgeoning	2 lb.	Light, thrown (20/60)
	Mace (Inquisitor's Gavel)	5 GC	1d6 bludgeoning	4 lb.	—
	Quarterstaff (Dragon-Bone Staff)	2 ss	1d6 bludgeoning	4 lb.	Versatile (1d8)
	Sickle (Harvest Blade)	1 GC	1d4 slashing	2 lb.	Light
	Spear (Blank's Pike)	1 GC	1d6 piercing	3 lb.	Thrown (20/60), versatile (1d8)
	Name	Cost	Damage	Weight	Properties
	Crossbow, Light (Vortex Hand-Bow)	25 GC	1d8 piercing	5 lb.	Ammo (80/320), loading, two-handed

	Dart (Throwing Needle)	5 cf	1d4 piercing	1/4 lb.	Finesse, thrown (20/60)	
	Shortbow (Hunter's Bow)	25 GC	1d6 piercing	2 lb.	Ammo (80/320), two-handed	
	Sling (Sump-Slinger)	1 ss	1d4 bludgeoning	—	Ammo (30/120)	
	Name	Cost	Damage	Weight	Properties	Fo H
	Battleaxe (Ignis War-Axe)	10 GC	1d8 slashing	4 lb.	Versatile (1d10)	H Ig
	Flail (Penitent's Chain)	10 GC	1d8 bludgeoning	2 lb.	—	C of th Si
	Glaive (Ferrum Wall-Blade)	20 GC	1d10 slashing	6 lb.	Heavy, reach, two-handed	H Fe
	Greataxe (Pyre Executioner)	30 GC	1d12 slashing	7 lb.	Heavy, two-handed	H Py
	Greatsword (True Steel Blade)	50 GC	2d6 slashing	6 lb.	Heavy, two-handed	H Py
	Halberd (Ignis War-Scythe)	20 GC	1d10 slashing	6 lb.	Heavy, reach, two-handed	H Ig
	Lance (Vortex Sky-Lance)	10 GC	1d12 piercing	6 lb.	Reach, special	H V
	Longsword (Archon's Blade)	15 GC	1d8 slashing	3 lb.	Versatile (1d10)	H O

	Maul (Stone-Blood Crusher)	10 GC	2d6 bludgeoning	10 lb.	Heavy, two-handed	St sm
	Morningstar (Tenebris Flayer)	15 GC	1d8 piercing	4 lb.	—	Hi To
	Pike (Blank Line-Spear)	5 GC	1d10 piercing	18 lb.	Heavy, reach, two-handed	M
	Rapier (Obsidian Glass-Blade)	25 GC	1d8 piercing	2 lb.		
	Purity	DC	Safe Spells			
	0% (Blank)	20	Cantrips only			
	15% (Lesser)	17	Cantrips + 1st			
	40% (Archon)	12	1st–3rd			
	60%	8	1st–5th			
	80%	4	1st–7th			

95%+ (Sovereign)	2
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Cannot
cast
while
dormant

Spell Level	Damage
1	1d6
2	2d6
3	3d6
4	4d6
5	5d6
6	6d6
7	7d6

8
9

8d6

9d6

Damage ignores all resistances.

Races & Ascension Ages

XP Thresholds

Race	Ascension Age	Lifespan	Purity Range
Human	15	70	0–100%
Dracon-Kin	12	80	25–100%
Stone-Blood	25	350	10–30%
Ash-Walker	15	120	1d100
Deep-Blood	30	750	Age-decay
Sump-Blood	15	150	0–15%
Bone-Wrought	N/A	N/A	0%
Half-Breed	18	180	11–60%

- Level 1: 300 XP
- Level 2: 900 XP
- Level 3: 2,700 XP
- Level 4: 6,500 XP
- Level 5: 14,000 XP
- Level 6: 23,000 XP
- Level 7: 34,000 XP
- Level 8: 48,000 XP

- Level 9: 64,000 XP

- Level 10: 85,000 XP

Solis-Grave: Shadows of the Crown